

MONEYLEAGUE Rankings — The Honest Version

May 2026 · Sleeper era 2023-2025

Multiple defensible metrics, ranked, with my opinion at the end. No cherry-picking, no obfuscation. If the numbers say something, the numbers say it.

Championships (the only ring that matters)

Year	Champion
2023	Eric
2024	Coop
2025	Trevor

Three different winners in three years. No repeat champs. Eight of twelve current managers still have zero titles in the Sleeper era. Each year someone different has unlocked it.

Regular-Season Wins (2023-25, 42 games)

Rank	Manager	Total W	Best year	Notes
1	Brower	33	—	
2	Ankur	25	—	
3	Josh	25	—	
4	Trevor	25	—	 2025
5	Donnie	20	—	
6	Troy	20	—	
7	Kyle	20	—	
8	Coop	20	—	 2024
9	Eric	19	—	 2023
10	Tim	17	—	
11	Lem	14	—	
12	Brian	14	—	

Brower has more regular-season wins than anyone — 33 of 42 (79%) — but no title. That's the playoff-variance tax: you can dominate the season and still get bounced in one bad Sunday.

True Team Strength — Expected Wins

Computed as **all-play expected wins**: your weekly score compared against every other team's that week. Removes schedule noise entirely.

Rank	Manager	Expected W	Actual W	Gap
1	Brower	33.2	33	-0.2
2	Coop	28.9	20	-8.9
3	Kyle	28.0	20	-8.0
4	Troy	27.6	20	-7.6
5	Eric	27.6	19	-8.6
6	Ankur	27.0	25	-2.0
7	Donnie	26.8	20	-6.8
8	Josh	23.6	25	+1.4
9	Brian	23.5	14	-9.5
10	Trevor	23.5	25	+1.5
11	Lem	22.8	14	-8.8
12	Tim	20.5	17	-3.5

This is **the most accurate measure of who's been good** in our league. Brower remains #1 (no surprise — most wins AND most points). What's interesting is the bottom: Brian, Lem, and Tim all have fewer expected wins than several teams they outranked in actual wins. They're not unlucky — they're just losing.

Total Points Scored (42 games)

Rank	Manager	Total PF	PPG
1	Brower	4952	117.9
2	Kyle	4790	114.1
3	Troy	4725	112.5
4	Coop	4699	111.9
5	Donnie	4666	111.1
6	Ankur	4624	110.1
7	Eric	4574	108.9

Rank	Manager	Total PF	PPG
8	Brian	4503	107.2
9	Josh	4502	107.2
10	Trevor	4499	107.1
11	Lem	4411	105.0
12	Tim	4318	102.8

Same shape as expected wins, because that's what expected wins is measuring. Brower's lead here is enormous — he's averaged **117.9 PPG vs the league median of ~109**. That 8-point edge week after week is what built his 33-win record.

Draft VBD (3-year cumulative)

Rank	Manager	3-yr Draft VBD	Per year
1	Donnie	+1868	+623
2	Brian	+1548	+516
3	Lem	+1451	+484
4	Ankur	+1347	+449
5	Trevor	+1122	+374
6	Eric	+1051	+350
7	Tim	+858	+286
8	Josh	+803	+268
9	Coop	+720	+240
10	Brower	+601	+200
11	Troy	+581	+194
12	Kyle	+397	+132

Draft skill measured strictly: above-replacement points delivered by drafted players (keepers excluded). The champions (Eric, Coop, Trevor) all ranked top-5 here.

Drafting is the controllable thing that most correlates with winning.

Wire Production (FA adds only, no trades)

Rank	Manager	3-yr Wire pts
1	Trevor	+2002
2	Brower	+1960
3	Lem	+1933

Rank	Manager	3-yr Wire pts
4	Coop	+1879
5	Josh	+1814
6	Troy	+1808
7	Kyle	+1753
8	Brian	+1652
9	Ankur	+1350
10	Eric	+1179
11	Tim	+966
12	Donnie	+827

Wire pickup production (not including trade acquisitions). Volume managers — Brower, Trevor, Brian — tend to top this ranking. Selective managers underperform here by definition but make up for it elsewhere.



Luck Standings — Actual vs Expected Wins

Rank	Manager	Actual W	Expected W	Luck
1	Trevor	25	23.5	+1.5
2	Josh	25	23.6	+1.4
3	Brower	33	33.2	-0.2
4	Ankur	25	27.0	-2.0
5	Tim	17	20.5	-3.5
6	Donnie	20	26.8	-6.8
7	Troy	20	27.6	-7.6
8	Kyle	20	28.0	-8.0
9	Eric	19	27.6	-8.6
10	Lem	14	22.8	-8.8
11	Coop	20	28.9	-8.9
12	Brian	14	23.5	-9.5

Positive luck = won more than your points deserved. Negative luck = the schedule has been hostile. **Trevor and Josh have been the league's beneficiaries. The most schedule-unlucky managers will regress upward in 2026 — that's not a hope, that's math.**

My Take — Who's Actually Been Good

Synthesizing all of the above, here's my opinion on what the data says, separating skill from luck:

 **Best overall manager (skill, not luck): Brower.** Most points scored, most actual wins, most expected wins — three different metrics, same answer. The only thing missing is a title, which is a coin flip every January.

 **Best drafter: Donnie** (+1868 3-yr VBD). The actual edge in the controllable phase of the year. Hasn't yet converted to a title because drafting alone doesn't win December.

 **Luckiest: Trevor** (+1.5 wins above expectation). Significant slice of Trevor's record is schedule. Probably regresses in 2026.

 **Most unlucky: Brian** (-9.5 wins below expectation). Has been a better team than the record shows. Bet on the bounce-back.

 **Most work to do: Tim** (20.5 expected wins over 3 years). Not luck — just hasn't scored enough points. The answer for 2026: better draft, more wire activity.

The honest answer about the league: this is a tight league. Outside of Brower's clear top-tier dominance and Tim's clear bottom-tier struggle, **the middle 8 managers are all within ~6 expected wins of each other across 42 games.**

That's why we have three different champs in three years. Any of these teams can win it. The question is who'll have the peak draft year + favorable schedule when their turn comes.

All rankings from offline Sleeper data dump. Regular season only (W1-W14). Draft VBD uses post-Yahoo-trade xlsx attribution for 2023. Wire production excludes trade acquisitions. "Expected wins" = $14 \times (\text{all-play wins} \div 462 \text{ max})$.